



MOROCCO

Kingdom of light



MARRAKECH

Hidden Gems and more

Why Morocco?



Authentic, stylish, diverse, and just three hours from the UK, Morocco, offers an exciting array of flavours, landscapes, architecture and activities to engage every traveller.

From the fashionable riads of Marrakech, the historic city of Fez and the turquoise blue Mediterranean coast to the golden Atlantic sands, the epic Sahara desert to the towering Atlas mountain ranges, there is an incredible amount on offer to explore.

There is a multitude of hidden gems in Morocco - the Kingdom of Light - putting Africa on the map as a fully mainstream destination.

More tourists are choosing to travel to beautiful Morocco, no matter what their trip. Whether they are solo travellers, couples, families or to hold a business event – there is a city suitable for anyone to explore.

The weather in Morocco is warm and the welcome even warmer. It is the house of the sun and has a long tradition of hospitality that exists to this day. In Morocco, you will find a diverse range of cities to explore, all with a multitude of hidden gems.

For more details on best places to visit, see the **Visit Morocco website here.**



MOROCCO
Kingdom of light



Marrakech hidden gems



Marrakech: Discovering the Red City in three days

Within its walls, the Red City's medina streets are alive with activity. A hubbub of voices calling back and forth, vibrant colours, fragrances of cedar and spices, soaked in the history of five dynasties. Sounds, smells and colours unite to compose an astonishing sensorial symphony.

A perennial fixture of many 'Top 10 destination' lists, Marrakech never loses its magical appeal. A three-day tour of the city offers a feast for the senses and here's an example of what you could do during your stay.

Day One

Morning

Start your exploration of Marrakech by discovering its past - step through one of the historical gates of the old Medina and discover old fountains and ancient buildings, taste bread baked in a traditional bakery, and watch artisans in the Fondouks create their wares with skills handed down through the generations.

A particular highlight is the 16th-century Ben Youssef Medersa, one of the finest examples of Moroccan architecture in Marrakech, and don't miss the archaeological site of the Almoravid Qubba dome, which is the oldest monument in the city.

Afternoon

Take a relaxing trip on a Caleche (horse-drawn carriage) through the streets to the famous garden created by the orientalist painter, Jacques Majorelle. Plants from the four corners of the world flourish amidst elegant ornamental ponds, while fifteen bird species flutter in and out. At the centre is the iconic Art Deco villa painted in the beautifully rich shade of bold cobalt blue that is named after the artist.

Afterwards visit the beautifully designed "Berber Museum" next door, which displays Yves Saint Laurent's personal collection of Amazigh (Berber) antiques.

The trip would not be complete without visiting the iconic, Yves Saint Laurent Museum, one of the most recent additions to Marrakech. The museum is entirely devoted

to the work of the legendary fashion designer, who first holidayed in the city during 1966.

Day Two

Dedicate your day to exploring the mighty High Atlas mountain range, a short trip south of the city. Visit traditional Amazigh villages in the foothills before arriving at the Toubkal National Park where you can hike and explore in abundance taking in the park landscapes of cliffs, gorges, plateaus and valleys, and spot wildlife of mouflon and birds such as the Royal Eagle, Booted Eagle and Short-toed Eagle. You can then immerse yourself at the Eco museum learning about nature and the amazing ecosystems of the park. From there trek to Imlil at 1,470m and enjoy panoramic views of Ait Mizane Valley and its surrounding peaks.



Day Three

Morning

On your final day walk through the intricately decorated Bab Debbagh, one of the most eastern and oldest gates of the medina and see the traditional leather tanneries, tinsmiths and wood painters, before visiting the Museum of Photography, and the Museum Douiria Mouassine, the latter a gem of private restored architecture dating back to the 16th century.

Afternoon

After a traditional Moroccan meal and mint tea at a local cafe, continue on to Dar Cherifa, a medieval aristocratic house, which is now a museum of art and cultural hosting exhibitions, workshops and concerts. Located in the heart of the souks, the property is a hidden gem of the Saadian era. End your three days with a stroll along Dar El Bacha Street to see the splendid art galleries of the Medina.

For more details on Marrakech
www.visitmorocco.com/marrakech

Hidden Gems in Marrakech

Water Museum

The first structure of its kind in the Arab world dedicated to Moroccan, Arab and Muslim hydraulic heritage

The World of Finery Arts - This museum in the historic district of the Kasbah is home to more than 3,000 pieces of fine jewellery, ornaments and other ceremonial clothing

Anima Garden

Created by the universal artist Andre Heller this enamelled, fancy botanical garden showcases a remarkable space fusing tourism, with social and ecological sustainability

Koutoubia Mosque

One of the most impressive monuments in Marrakesh and the most beautiful mosques of the Western Muslim world dating back to 1157

The Menara Garden

One of the oldest gardens of the Muslim west that includes a huge orchard and water basin intended for the irrigation of fruit trees and vegetables

The Bab El Khemis souk

A flea market dedicated to clothes and utility objects

The Secret Garden

Part of the great tradition of stately Arab-Andalusian and Moroccan palaces, the doors to this complex dating back to the Saadian times is now opening its doors to the public. It includes outstanding examples of Islamic art, architecture and magnificent gardens

Agafay Desert

Not far from Marrakech, this desert is surrounded by majestic rocky mountains resembling a moon crater and is becoming an on-trend location for star gazing and luxury glamping

Marrakech Palm Grove

This is a palm oasis of several hundred thousand trees that was once, according to legend, said to be created from date seeds cast off centuries ago, and was created during the Almoravid period.

And more...



Essaouira

Essaouira, the “Bride of the Atlantic” is a seaside resort of beauty set in a natural landscape, one of the most wooded in the whole of Morocco. The ecosystem is composed of pine forests, dunes, lakes and a wild coast that is being preserved amidst an environmentally conscious tourism.

Its architecture includes houses with white and blue facades and crenellated walls. You can walk quietly in the shade of its ramparts (made famous from the Astapor city in the Game of Thrones series) or partake in an array of watersports that take advantage of the winds.

From the working fishing port to the streets of the Medina, Essaouira is ranked one of Morocco’s most beautiful cities by UNESCO.

It is also home to the only vineyard estate in Morocco to have obtained organic certification, Domaine Du Val D’Argan that is nestled in the hollow of a valley amidst the shade of argan and olive trees.

For more details on Essaouira
www.visitmorocco.com/essaouira



Fez

Be transported back in time in the city of Fez. For travellers who are passionate about exploring a nation’s heritage and eager for a taste of Moroccan authenticity this historic city is the place to visit.

Fez is the oldest of the Imperial Cities and the seventh century Medina is a UNESCO World Heritage Site, the largest urban car-free space in the world. Thick walls surround the old quarter, punctuated by beautifully ornate gateways, such as the stunning Bab Boujeloud.

Inside are numerous refurbished monuments, allowing visitors to see how Fez appeared hundreds of years ago, preserving the history for future generations. Take time to track down the Medersa Bou Inania and Medersa el-Attarine, two spectacular Islamic schools, which are stunning examples of the intricate stucco and tile work so typical of Moroccan architecture.

Other must-sees are the Foundouk Nejjarine, an ancient caravansary that’s now Musée des Arts et Métiers du Bois (Museum of Woodworking). The top floor of the Foundouk has an amazing panoramic view of the city’s rooftops. Alternatively, traverse Fez-El Jdid, home to a historic Royal Palace, which is still used on occasion by the King of Morocco today, and the Jewish quarter with its famous jewellery markets. Outside of Fez are the Merenid tombs, high up on a hill offering spectacular views over the city below.

For more details on Fez
www.visitmorocco.com/fes



Beyond Marrakech...

And more...



Rabat

The capital of Morocco, Rabat is a beautiful city that deserves to be better known. With wide boulevards and extensive parks, it is the country's political and administrative centre, and home to the royal palace and embassies.

It is also a place for both cultural and seaside activities. On the waterfront, there is the Corniche for shady terraces in gourmet restaurants, beaches, sports, and nightlife. There is also a first-class yachting harbour.

The city is home to many international cultural institutes and a wide variety of museums. There are traditional souks and spice markets in the Medina and an impressive fish market, as well as more modern tourist areas and boutiques.

A popular destination is the Kasbah Oudayas, the Kasbah was built five centuries before the corsairs came, as a concentration point for soldiers on their way to reconquest Al Andalus. During the corsair period, the Kasbah was the place where these corsairs

had their houses and their diwan. At that time, Salé was called "Old Sally", Rabat was called "New Sally" and the Oudayas "the Kasbah".

A city within a city, it is full of charm, with its blue and white buildings, quiet flowered alleyways, mild ocean breezes and scents from its Andalusian gardens.

Hassan Tower is perhaps the city's most spectacular attraction. Built by Yacoub El-Mansour around the year 1,200, it was planned to be part of the largest mosque in the world but was never completed. The tower and the two hundred columns surrounding it give testimony to the ambition of El-Mansour. Across the square is the Mohammed V Mausoleum, containing the tombs of King Mohammad V and his two sons, King Hassan II and Prince Moulay Abdellah. Step inside, be peaceful, and marvel at the beautiful gilded interiors, ornate furnishings, and the Alaouite Dynasty's architectural style.

For more details on Rabat
www.visitmorocco.com/rabat



Tanger

Standing at the northern tip of Morocco, where the Mediterranean Sea meets the Atlantic Ocean and only a few miles across from the Spanish mainland, Tangier is the gateway to Africa.

It is a busy and well-connected city, home to the largest port in the country and its dual heritage makes it all the more attractive. The treasures of Hispano-Moorish architecture are entwined with a wonderful craft industry that go hand in hand. White colonial-era buildings and European-style squares mix with the narrow winding streets and high walls decorated with intricate geometric carvings, so characteristic of Moorish architecture.

You will easily spend your morning exploring the twisting alleys and souks of the lively medina. In its streets, you will find a treasure trove of artisan goods, hear the tools of the craftsmen and smell the fruits adorning the many market stalls.

Come the afternoon, take a seat outside one of the many cafes surrounding the open square to watch the world go by.

Tangier has recently been the beneficiary of major regeneration - head down to the waterfront and you'll see the shiny new marina full of pleasure boats, and wide boulevards lined with gently nodding palm trees. Several international hotel chains have recently opened in the city, and many other independent hotels and resorts have also been built.



And more...

And more...



Well-being and Adventure

Well-being

A wellness trip to Morocco is the perfect way to give mind, body, and spirit some well-deserved TLC. SPA, thalassotherapy, balneotherapy or thermalism are all practices to help you reach nirvana!

While the amazing climate is enough to lighten the soul by itself, coupled with a yoga session on the roof of a riad looking out at the Atlas Mountains, or surfing lessons in the warm Atlantic waters, it brings about a wonderful sense of peace and freedom.

Many of the resorts and hotels in Morocco have state-of-the-art wellness suites, which blend world-class modern treatments with centennial traditional techniques. Of course, Morocco is also the home of the Moorish

hammams - practised using local products such as black soap, argan oil and Rhassoul clay - that all offer a divine pampering experience.

Whether you go on a specific wellness retreat or just take some hours out of your holiday for some 'you time', in Morocco you'll be left feeling refreshed and restored from top to toe.

Adventure

If an outdoor adventure is more your scene, four mountain ranges, two coastlines, and one amazing desert offer you the chance to head off Morocco's beaten track for an epic experience you'll never forget.

The Sahara is an intense, glorious landscape that rewards exploration. The dunes and

sands offer an environment that is at once harsh and beautiful; during the day travel is across white, yellow, and orange sands under rich blue skies, while nights are spent around a campfire under a sky sparkling with more stars than you've ever seen. Organised tours are available from many towns on the edge of the desert such as Merzouga (Erg Chebbi), south Errachidia, and M'hamid El Ghizlane (Erg Chegaga), south Zagora.

Trekking in the huge Atlas Mountains gives you the chance to travel through an incredible range of different environments. It is possible to visit Amazigh villages, ancient ruins, snow-capped peaks, lush green valleys, and deep gorges with fast-flowing rivers, sometimes all in one day.

For keen cyclists, in particular, Morocco has great roads, amazing climate, and breathtaking views. Whether your preference is to eat up the miles on Morocco's roads, or ride off the beaten track for some off-road adventures, cycling to see the sights is an excellent way to discover Morocco. The Atlas Mountains are prime riding territory, whether you're touring or just want to spend a day or two exploring from the saddle. You'll pass through small villages, waterfalls and along lush green valleys on your travels - the scenery is quite spectacular.

Travel in these incredible regions can also be on foot, horseback or even by boat - white water rafting is an extremely popular activity here.



Instagrammable hit list

Morocco is a visually stunning country that offers a diverse range of landscapes and architecture, making it a destination for photographers and Instagram enthusiasts.

From vibrant cities to sprawling deserts and stunning beaches, Morocco is full of Insta-worthy spots that are sure to leave you in awe. Here are some Instagrammable places in Morocco:

Oualidia Lagoon

A stunning lagoon surrounded by lush greenery and crystal clear waters, perfect for capturing breathtaking landscapes.

Assilah

A coastal town known for its blue-washed buildings, street art, and picturesque beaches.

Tinmel Mosque, Al Haouz Province

An 11th-century mosque nestled in the Atlas Mountains that offers breathtaking views of the surrounding landscape.

Medina Rooftops, Marrakech

This bustling city is full of stunning rooftop terraces that offer panoramic views of the city and the surrounding mountains.

Ait Benhaddou Ksar, Ouarzazate

A historic ksar (fortified village) that has been used as a backdrop in many films and TV shows, and offers a glimpse into Morocco's rich history and architecture.

Bin El Ouidane Lac

A serene lake located in the Atlas Mountains of Morocco. Surrounded by towering cliffs and lush greenery, the lake is a picturesque haven for those seeking peace and tranquility.

Imsouane

A small fishing village known for its breathtaking beaches and charming houses, making it a popular destination for travelers.

Moulay Ismail Mausoleum, Meknes

A beautiful mausoleum that houses the tomb of Moulay Ismail, one of Morocco's most famous rulers.

Chefchaouen

A small mountain town known for its blue-washed buildings, making it a popular destination for photographers and Instagram enthusiasts.

Akchour

A stunning waterfall surrounded by lush greenery and rolling hills, making it a perfect place for nature lovers.

Agafay Desert, Marrakech

A vast desert landscape that offers a unique and dramatic backdrop for photographers and Instagram enthusiasts.

Ourika Valley

A stunning valley surrounded by lush greenery and rolling hills, offering breathtaking views of Morocco's stunning landscape.

Ouzoud Falls

A breathtaking waterfall surrounded by verdant vegetation and rolling hills, making it an ideal location for those who appreciate nature.

Merzouga dunes

A vast desert landscape that offers towering sand dunes and stunning sunsets, making it a popular spot for photographers and Instagram enthusiasts.

La Mamounia

A luxury hotel and spa in Marrakech known for its stunning gardens, pools, and architecture, making it a popular spot for capturing beautiful moments in Morocco.





MOROCCO



MARRAKECH

Hidden Gems and more